

MOTIVATION



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A Heads-up!

- This presentation includes topics related to mental health disorders, such as eating disorders, stress, and emotional well-being. Some content may be sensitive or emotionally challenging
- If you feel uncomfortable at any point, please feel free to pause, take a break, or reach out for support
- Your well-being is important

Stand up and Stretch!

Why we do the things we do?



What is Motivation?

- Latin word *movere*, which means “to move”
- Motivation is what “moves” people to do the things they do
- The process by which activities are **started**, **directed**, and **continued** so that physical or psychological needs or wants are met



Types of Motivation?

Extrinsic motivation

A person performs an action because it leads to an outcome that is separate from the person



Intrinsic motivation

A person performs an action because the act itself is rewarding or satisfying in some internal manner



How did Studying Motivation Begin?

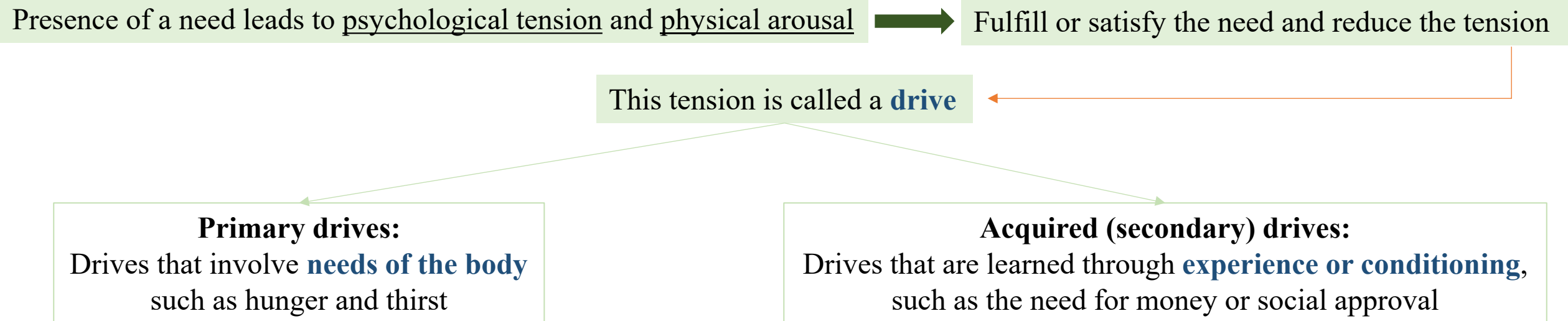
Evolutionary Approach

- **Instincts**: biologically determined and **innate patterns** of behavior that exist in both people and animals
- Unlearned
- E.g., in animals: nest building, mating, territory protection
- In humans, reproduction, fear, survival, anger, love, laughter, curiosity etc.
- Hereditary factors may account for more than 50% variance in aspects of human cognition, temperament, and personality

How did Studying Motivation Begin? (cont'd...)

Drive-reduction theory (Clark Hull)

- Focusses on the concept of needs and drives
- A need is a requirement of some material that is **essential for survival** of the organism
- E.g., food or water



How did Studying Motivation Begin? (cont'd...)

Primary drives:

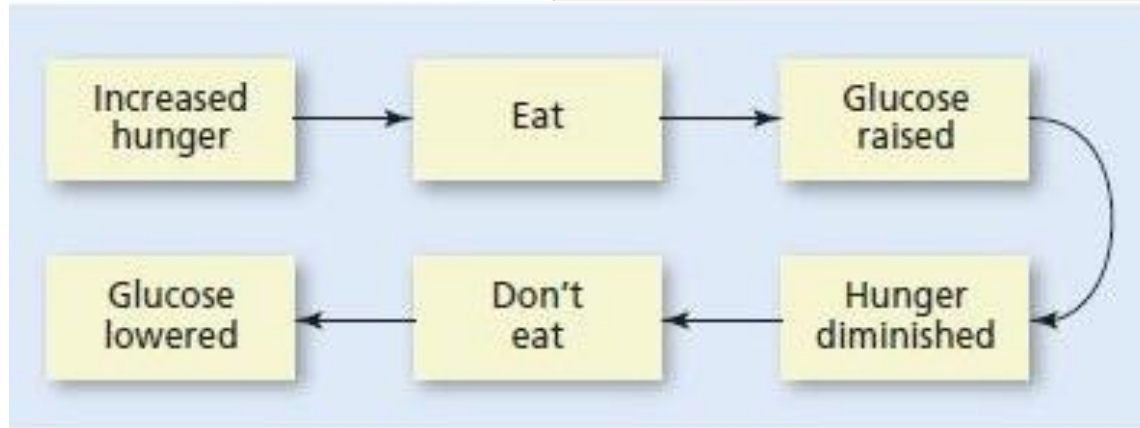
Drives that involve **needs of the body** such as hunger and thirst

E.g., after staying up late to complete assignments or scroll social media, students experience fatigue and drowsiness, which signal the body's need for sleep

Acquired (secondary) drives:

Drives that are learned through **experience or conditioning**, such as the need for money or social approval

E.g., the desire for high grades is a secondary drive because it is learned through cultural and educational experiences, and reinforced by rewards like praise, scholarships, or job prospects

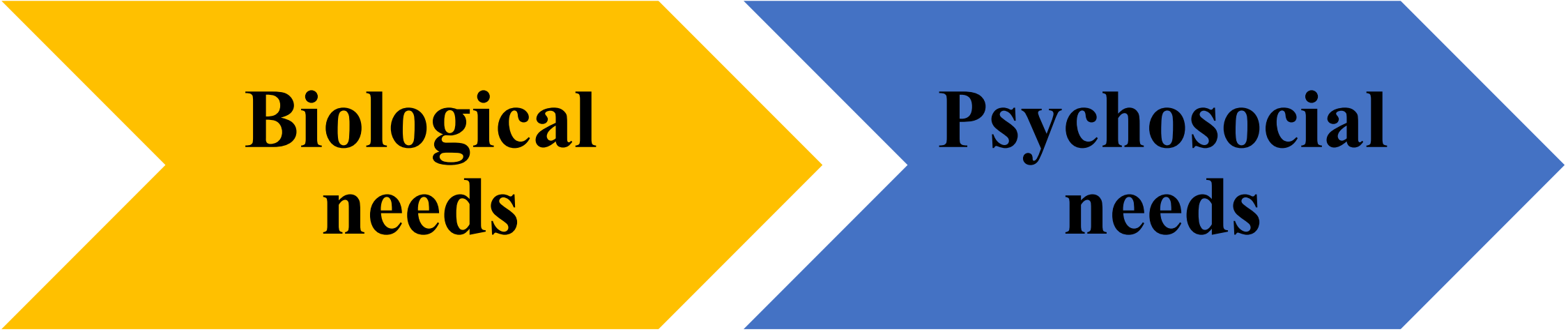


Homeostasis: The tendency of the body to maintain a steady state (body's version of thermostats)



- Drive-reduction theory explains the actions people take to reduce tension created by needs
- However, why do people eat when they are not really hungry?
- People don't always seek to reduce their inner arousal either; sometimes they seek to increase it
- Motivation is complex and multi-dimensional
- Influenced by: needs, level of arousal, external incentives, personal meaning & importance

Types of Needs

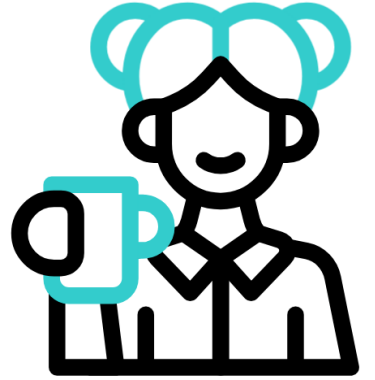


**Biological
needs**

**Psychosocial
needs**



Biological Needs



Biological Needs: Hunger

- Satisfying hunger is one of our most primary needs
- Eating is not only a basic survival behavior that reduces a primary drive
- Contraction of stomach where there a lack of food

Physiological factors:

Hormonal influences

- Insulin: helps absorb glucose from the bloodstream for energy
- Leptin: controls appetite; signals body to stop; satiated

The Brain

- Hypothalamus
- Ventromedial hypothalamus (VMH): stops eating response when glucose levels go up
- Lateral hypothalamus (LH): influence the onset of eating when insulin goes up

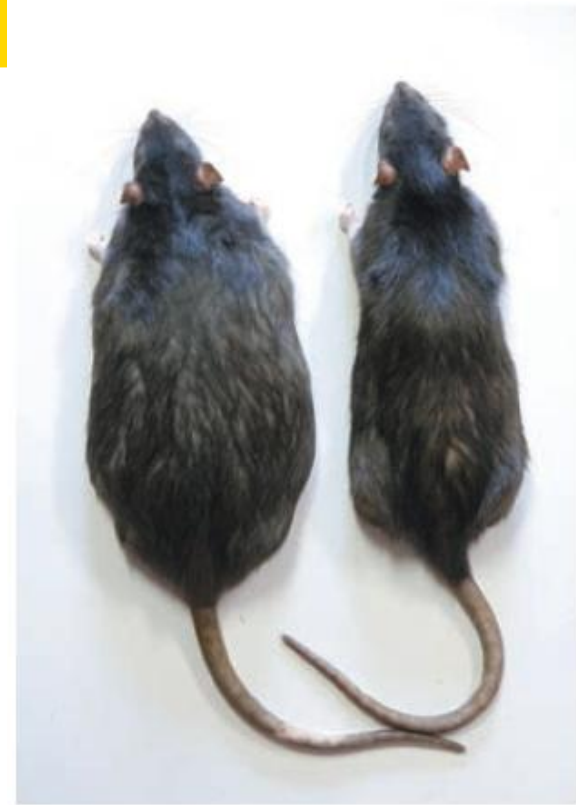


Figure 9.4 Obese Laboratory Rat

The rat on the left has reached a high level of obesity because its ventromedial hypothalamus has been deliberately damaged in the laboratory. The result is a rat that no longer receives signals of being satiated, and so the rat continues to eat and eat and eat.